

MORE SCIENTISTS



Maggie Aderin-Pocock
1968–present

Space scientist Maggie designed instruments to orbit the Earth on board the James Webb Space Telescope. She is also a well-known science communicator who shares the wonders of space with millions of people on television.



Frederick Banting
1891–1941

A disease called diabetes was very difficult to treat before Canadian scientist Frederick and his assistant discovered insulin, in 1921. This hormone is produced by the pancreas of people without diabetes, and it can be made outside the body and used to control blood sugar.



Ben Barres
1954–2017

Ben's work showed how mysterious cells called glia are an essential part of our brain—they help nerves to grow and make connections. Ben was a transgender man and became an inspirational role model for LGBTQ+ scientists.



Robert Boyle
1627–1691

Boyle's Law is Robert's famous description of how squeezing a gas changes the space that it takes up. His careful experiments helped him make dozens of other discoveries, too, in physics, medicine, Earth sciences, and chemistry.



Sigmund Freud
1856–1939

The research of Austrian neurologist Sigmund completely changed the way people understood human behavior. His ideas about how the human brain worked also helped him to invent a new type of therapy, called psychoanalysis.



Margherita Hack
1922–2013

Italian astrophysicist Margherita studied stars and their atmospheres. She transformed an observatory in Italy into a world-leading research center that helped to plan one of the most productive satellites ever launched—the International Ultraviolet Explorer.



Edmond Halley
1656–1742

Edmond was the first astronomer to catalog the stars visible from the Southern Hemisphere (half of the Earth south of the equator). But, he is most famous for proving that three comets spotted in 1531, 1607, and 1682 were the same comet, now called Halley's Comet.



Alma Levant Hayden
1927–1967

Alma was one of the first African-American scientists to work for the US government. She was talented at using a technique called spectrophotometry to identify different chemicals. In one famous case, she proved that a supposed cure for cancer was really a fraud.